TCI Express Ltd

Concall tracker report · Q2 2027 (Sep 2026 quarter) · prepared 11 Nov 2026

1. Snapshot

An express parcel and cargo delivery company for businesses: it moves time-sensitive B2B shipments by road (Surface Express, its largest business), domestic and international air, rail and a small e-commerce service. About half its business comes from small and mid-sized firms and half from large customers. It runs an asset-light model with its own branches and sorting centres.

- Market cap about Rs 1,893 cr at about 20 times profit.
- FY26 sales Rs 1,236 cr, up only 2% after a 4% fall in FY25: three years of no real growth.
- FY26 net profit Rs 90 cr, down from Rs 139 cr in FY23: profit has shrunk as margins fell.
- Operating margin about 11% vs 15-16% in FY22-FY24: margins well below their old level.
- Sep 2026 quarter: revenue Rs 336 cr, up about 9%; EBITDA up about 11% at a 12.7% margin, best in five quarters; profit Rs 27 cr, up 6%.
- Net cash about Rs 77 cr: no debt problem.

2. Concall coverage

Quarter / source	Date	Read?
Q3 FY24 to Q3 FY25 (6 calls)	Feb 2024 - Feb 2025	Yes (scanned for guidance)
Q4 FY25	Jun 2025	Yes (scanned)
Q1 FY26	Aug 2025	Yes (scanned)
Q2 FY26	Nov 2025	Yes (scanned)
Q3 FY26	Feb 2026	Yes (scanned)
Q4 FY26	Jun 2026	Yes (scanned)
Q1 FY27	Aug 2026	Yes (scanned)
Q2 FY27	5 Nov 2026	Yes, in full

Fourteen transcripts over about three years; the latest was read in full.

Latest concall highlights - Q2 FY27 (5 Nov 2026)

- Revenue up about 9%, volume 265,000 tonnes, up 7.5%. EBITDA up about 11%, margin 12.7%, best in five quarters.
- Growth by business: Surface Express about 9%, Domestic Air 29%, International Air 26%, E-Commerce Express about 52% (small base).
- Management again committed double-digit volume and revenue growth for FY27, with 14-15%+ growth in the next two quarters and margins up 50-100 basis points over last year.
- Capex about Rs 80 cr in the first half for branches, a sorting centre and IT; net cash about Rs 77 cr.
- A long-time shareholder said growth had fully stopped for years; management agreed it hadn't grown for two to three years.

Business mix & capacity

- Domestic vs export: almost all domestic; International Air Express is a small, fast-growing line.

- Capacity: utilisation numbers were not given this call; management credited higher capacity utilisation across the network for the margin gain.

3. Earning trigger thesis

The hoped-for driver is a return to growth: faster-growing air and e-commerce lines on top of the main surface business, more SME customers, and better use of the sorting centres and automation already built. Margins have edged up for three quarters. But the same double-digit growth promise has been made almost every year since FY24 and missed each time.

Trigger	What management said	Evidence so far	Time horizon	Strength
Return to double-digit growth	Double-digit volume and revenue growth (said for FY25, FY26 and FY27)	FY25 sales fell, FY26 grew 2%; Q2 FY27 up 9%	FY27	Weak: repeatedly missed
Air and e-commerce lines	Scale the faster lines	Domestic Air 29%, International Air 26%, E-com 52%	Ongoing	Moderate, small base
Margin recovery	Margins up 100-150 bps in FY27 (Jun 2026), then 50-100 bps (Nov 2026)	Q2 margin 12.7% vs 12.4%	FY27	Moderate

3b. Trigger check

Trigger type	Yes/No	What was said (date)
Debt cut	No	-
New business	Yes	E-Commerce Express refocused on D2C and smaller merchants, growing about 52% (Nov 2026)
Margin up	Yes	EBITDA margin best in five quarters on better utilisation and cost discipline (Nov 2026)
New management	No	-
New capacity	No	Capex on branches and a sorting centre, no new hub start date given
Big orders	No	-
Turnaround	No	Management says growth journey 'has started', but no loss to recover from
Promoter buying	No	-

Single concrete driver: A return to growth from the faster air and e-commerce lines and better use of sorting centres already built, lifting margins.

3c. Margin bridge

EBITDA margin rose to 12.7% from 12.4% on higher network utilisation and cost control, but it's still well below the 15-16% of FY22-FY24. Higher depreciation kept profit growth to 6%. (lasting)

4. Management consistency scorecard

Period	What was promised	What actually happened	Verdict
Aug 2024	Double-digit revenue growth in FY25	FY25 sales fell 4%	Missed
Nov 2024 / Feb 2025	FY26 volume growth 13-15%, value 12-15%	Cut to about 8% volume, 10% revenue by Nov 2025; FY26 sales up 2%	Missed
Aug 2025	EBITDA margin back to 15-16% next year	Q2 FY27 margin 12.7%	Missed

Jun 2026	FY27: double-digit revenue growth, margin up 100-150 bps	H1 FY27 revenue up 8.8%; margin target trimmed to 50-100 bps	Partly
Jun 2026	Q1 FY27 growth of 9-10%	Achieved about 6.5%	Missed

The story hasn't changed, but the promises keep missing. Every year management guides double-digit growth and a return to old margins, then trims it mid-year. The tone this quarter was more upbeat as growth finally picked up, but the record says to wait for the numbers.

5. Bottom line

Durable earning trigger? → MAYBE

Growth has finally started to come back and margins are edging up, with air and e-commerce growing fast. But Surface Express, the bulk of the business, is still growing in single digits and there's no named catalyst beyond a hoped-for recovery.

Management consistent? → NO

Growth guidance has been missed two years running and trimmed again this year. The margin target has slipped too. Until it delivers a full year of what it promises, the guidance can't be trusted.

6. Checkpoints for next quarter

- December quarter revenue grows in double digits
- December quarter EBITDA margin stays above the September level
- Surface Express growth reaches double digits

Sources

- Screener.in concall transcripts Feb 2024 - Nov 2026
- Screener.in financial tables

This is not investment advice. Do your own due diligence.